ROLEEDGE · CONSULTING PREP

# Guesstimate Workbook

Master Market Sizing and Estimation Questions for Consulting & Strategy Interviews

| 16 | 45 | Print |
|---|---|---|
| SECTIONS | PRACTICE QUESTIONS | WITH SPACE TO WRITE |

**How to use this workbook:** print it, work through it in order, and write in the spaces. Every exercise has room for your answers, and you can print extra copies of any page.

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From **RoleEdge**, founded by Mayank Kapoor, former Manager at Bain & Company and Warwick MBA. Free to use and share.

## Why Guesstimates Matter in Consulting Interviews

Guesstimates test your ability to **think logically, structure problems, and stay calm under pressure.** Recruiters don't care if your number is exact—they care about your approach.

> EXAMPLE
> If asked "Estimate the number of ATMs in India," a random guess fails. Segmenting logically (population → banked households → ATM demand per household) impresses.

Consulting firms like McKinsey, BCG, and Bain use guesstimates to filter candidates who can **simplify ambiguity into structure.**

EXERCISE

Write one recent time you had to make a quick estimate at work or in daily life.

## The MECE Framework for Estimation

MECE = **Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive.** Break problems into non-overlapping parts that together cover the whole.

> EXAMPLE
> Estimate pizza consumption in India.
>
> - Break by **population** (urban vs rural).
> - Break by **frequency** (occasional vs regular eaters).
> - Break by **size** (small vs medium vs large).

MECE keeps you from double-counting and ensures logical coverage.

EXERCISE

Pick a guesstimate (e.g., number of Uber rides in Mumbai). Write your MECE breakdown.

STEP 1

## Break Down Populations and Segments

Every guesstimate starts with populations. Break them into **manageable, logical buckets.**

EXAMPLE

Number of toothpaste tubes sold annually in India.

- India's population ~1.4B.
- Assume 70% urban + semi-urban usage = ~1B people.
- Average person uses 4 tubes a year, so about 4B tubes annually.

EXERCISE

Pick 1 consumer good and estimate annual demand in your city.

STEP 2

## Identify Key Drivers & Assumptions

Assumptions drive estimates. State them clearly.

EXAMPLE

Estimate number of flights landing in Delhi daily.

- Drivers: Number of passengers, avg. plane capacity, % seat utilization.
- If Delhi handles ~200,000 passengers/day, planes average 200 seats, 80% occupancy → ~1,250 flights/day.

EXERCISE

Write 3 assumptions you'd need to estimate car washes in Mumbai.

STEP 3

## Apply Back-of-the-Envelope Math

Quick math is essential. Round numbers smartly.

- Instead of 1.38B → 1.4B.
- Instead of ₹47,000 → ₹50,000.

Clarity > Precision. Communicate your math as you go.

EXERCISE

Estimate the number of coffee cups sold daily at Starbucks in India.

STEP 4

## Validate with Sanity Checks

Always sanity check. If your result seems absurd (e.g., "100B pizzas annually in India"), revise assumptions.

Methods:

- Compare to known data.
- Use ratios ("1 ATM per 10,000 people").
- Check per capita feasibility.

EXERCISE

Take your coffee estimate and sanity check it against store counts.

## 10 Classic Guesstimate Questions

1. ☐ How many ATMs are there in India?
2. ☐ Estimate the number of Uber rides in Mumbai per day.
3. ☐ How many toothpaste tubes are sold annually in India?
4. ☐ Estimate the annual demand for air conditioners in Delhi.
5. ☐ How many Starbucks outlets can India sustain profitably?
6. ☐ Estimate the number of elevators in New York City.
7. ☐ How many cricket bats are sold in India annually?
8. ☐ Estimate the number of Ola drivers in Bangalore.
9. ☐ How many laptops are sold annually in the US?
10. ☐ Estimate the number of pizzas eaten per day in Mumbai.

WORKSHEET

Solve 1 question fully with MECE + assumptions.

## 10 Market Sizing Questions

1. ☐ Estimate the size of the online grocery market in India (2025).
2. ☐ Size the electric vehicle market in Europe.
3. ☐ Estimate annual SaaS spend by Indian startups.
4. ☐ Size the OTT video streaming market in the Middle East.
5. ☐ Estimate the wearable tech market in the US.
6. ☐ Size the organic food industry in urban India.
7. ☐ Estimate the online ed-tech market in Africa.
8. ☐ Size the global luxury watch market.
9. ☐ Estimate the Indian insurance premium market.
10. ☐ Size the cross-border remittance market in Southeast Asia.

## 10 Product Demand Questions

1. ☐ Estimate iPhone sales in India (next year).
2. ☐ How many washing machines are sold annually in Brazil?
3. ☐ Estimate annual demand for two-wheelers in Indonesia.
4. ☐ How many premium coffee machines are sold in Europe annually?
5. ☐ Estimate the demand for VR headsets in the US.
6. ☐ How many microwaves are sold annually in India?
7. ☐ Estimate demand for electric scooters in Vietnam.

8. ☐ How many cars are sold annually in Germany?
9. ☐ Estimate annual demand for bottled water in Dubai.
10. ☐ How many footballs are sold annually in Spain?

## 10 Service Usage Questions

1. ☐ Estimate the number of hotel rooms booked nightly in Dubai.
2. ☐ How many flights land daily in London Heathrow?
3. ☐ Estimate annual hospital visits in India.
4. ☐ How many haircuts are given daily in New York?
5. ☐ Estimate annual e-commerce orders in India.
6. ☐ How many cinema tickets are sold annually in France?
7. ☐ Estimate annual Uber Eats orders in Singapore.
8. ☐ How many parcels does FedEx deliver globally per day?
9. ☐ Estimate annual gym memberships sold in the US.
10. ☐ How many MBA applications are submitted annually worldwide?

## 5 Creative Guesstimates

1. ☐ Estimate the number of Tinder swipes in India per day.
2. ☐ How many dogs are there in Mumbai?
3. ☐ Estimate annual consumption of tea in the UK.
4. ☐ How many WhatsApp messages are sent globally each minute?
5. ☐ Estimate the number of job interviews happening worldwide today.

EXERCISE

Pick 1 creative question and build a MECE structure.

EXAMPLE

## A consulting interview guesstimate

*An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.*

**A candidate was asked:** "Estimate the number of gas stations in Delhi."

- Broke Delhi population (~20M) into households.
- Assumed 40% own vehicles → ~8M vehicles.
- Avg. vehicle fills 40L monthly → 320M liters/month.
- Avg. station dispenses 400,000L/month → ~800 stations.

The interviewer cared more about the structure than the final number.

> LESSON
>
> Structure > Accuracy.

## Common Mistakes and a 12-Week Plan

- ✕ Diving into math without structure.
- ✕ Forgetting sanity checks.
- ✕ Freezing under pressure.

## 12-week guesstimate practice plan

| When | Focus | My actions |
|---|---|---|
| Weeks 1–4 | Practice consumer goods (toothpaste, soap, coffee). | |
| Weeks 5–8 | Practice services (rides, hotels, flights). | |
| Weeks 9–12 | Practice market sizing (EVs, OTT, SaaS). | |

# Guesstimate worksheet 1

Pick any question from this workbook. Print this page as many times as you need.

THE QUESTION

CLARIFYING QUESTIONS I'D ASK

MY STRUCTURE (SEGMENTS)

ASSUMPTIONS

THE MATH

SANITY CHECK

FINAL ANSWER, IN ONE SENTENCE

# Guesstimate worksheet 2

Another worksheet for your next question.

THE QUESTION

CLARIFYING QUESTIONS I'D ASK

MY STRUCTURE (SEGMENTS)

ASSUMPTIONS

THE MATH

SANITY CHECK

FINAL ANSWER, IN ONE SENTENCE

# Guesstimate worksheet 3

Another worksheet for your next question.

THE QUESTION

CLARIFYING QUESTIONS I'D ASK

MY STRUCTURE (SEGMENTS)

ASSUMPTIONS

THE MATH

SANITY CHECK

FINAL ANSWER, IN ONE SENTENCE

## My notes

NEXT STEP

### Want someone to check your work?

Bring this workbook to a free call with RoleEdge. We'll go through your answers and help you plan what comes next.

Book a free call at roleedge.com/book